★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Gambling Jack

Famous card shark — undefeated for five years... until this week.

How to Play It

Show-off with a sore spot. Stay gracious about your loss, stick close to your backer Anna Belle, and act like a champion on his best behavior.

Starter Lines

1. Anna Belle, I couldn't have come this far without your backin'. You're my lucky charm, partner.
2. Holly, Mitch, Clay — that was one fine tournament. Tip of the hat to every one of you.
3. Billie, between you and me… can that Poker Alice be trusted with a deck of cards?

Be Ready If Asked

"How do you stay undefeated? I've been watching your hands..." → Laugh it off: pure skill, friend. If they keep pressing, slip them a few Deadwood dollars to drop it.

"How do you know Harry so well?" → "We go way back at the card tables. Old friends, that's all."

"Was there cheating in the tournament?" → "The cards just didn't fall my way. Ask the fellas who won."

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

OBJECTIVES

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Starting Objectives:

- Stand by Anna Belle (your backer) and make sure that she knows that she knows how much you treasure her support.
- Discreetly let Harry High-Stakes (the cantina owner) know that you will make sure he doesn't lose all of his money if he just keeps quiet about your secret.
- If confronted about your secret (that you cheat at poker), pay whomever to keep quiet.
- Congratulate the other poker players, Holly Hickok, Mitch Maverick and Clay Coldwell, on a great tournament.
- Find out from Billie-the-Bartender (the barmaid) if she thinks Poker Alice (the poker dealer) can be trusted.



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Gambling Jack

Known as the best of the best at poker, you are not accustomed to losing in any fashion. When you entered the Deadwood Poker tournament, you assumed an automatic win at the poker tables. However, when you realized that the tournament was being held by your old friend, Harry High-Stakes, you were not certain that a win was in the cards for you.

You first met Harry in his outlaw days when Harry spent a great deal of time with Jesse Wales (another outlaw). It was no secret that in those days Harry would go about stealing money and then lose it at cards at the nearest cantina or card house. At the card tables, Harry became a good friend of yours. Harry is the one who taught you to cheat, something you have mastered to a tee. In fact, you have become such a master at the art of cheating that NO ONE has ever caught you and for the last five years you have been on a winning streak. Because of your excellent slight of hand and ability to count cards, you have become known as the best hand in poker. Only Harry knows your secret of how you retain your reputation.

Once you found out that Harry was the organizer of the tournament, you were uncertain if Harry would condone your cheating ways at his tournament. However, when you arrived in Deadwood, Harry approached you with a proposal. Harry made it clear that he would allow you to cheat and keep your cheating a secret only if you would win the tournament and give back the winnings. (Despite the cantina's popularity, Harry owes the bank a great deal of money and he must repay that debt if he does not want to lose his cantina.) In order to save your reputation and your career as a professional card player, you agreed to Harry's request. Unfortunately, you experienced some bad luck and regardless of your best cheating efforts, you lost in the final round of the tournament. Because Harry was depending on you to win the tournament in order to save his cantina, you are worried about how Harry will react. More than anything, you need to keep Harry from telling your secret. If word gets out that you are a cheater, your career (and your good name) would be ruined!

In addition to letting Harry down by your loss, you are also worried about letting down your wealthy backer and longtime friend, Anna Belle. You met Anna Belle when you were just starting a highly unsuccessful career at card playing. Anna Belle's family fortune is what funded your career through those tough years of many financial losses. Since your career has made a distinct turnaround (when you started cheating), Anna Belle has stated that she is very happy she stood by you. Earlier today, Anna Belle was quite shocked when you lost the tournament and she insists that someone else must be cheating. Coincidentally, you think that Poker Alice (the poker dealer) may have witnessed you cheating, but she has yet to say anything. With the potential of your cheating secret being exposed, you fear losing Anna Belle's trust and, more importantly, her wealth. Anna Belle has a hot temper and you fear she may take it out on Holly Hickok, a female card player who has been sweet-talking with you (and all of the other male card players) all week.

While you fear Harry's reaction, you know that you must attend the Deadwood Poker Tournament Party in order to congratulate the winner, Mitch Maverick, and to make amends with Harry. At the party, you hope that Anna Belle does not make a scene about your losing or Holly's sweet-talk.



Acting and Dressing Your Part: A show-off to everyone, at the party you will have to constantly be on your best behavior, both in front of Anna Belle and those watching. Since you are a very successful poker player, you have a very distinguished wardrobe which may consist of a button down shirt, vest, tie and hat (bowler, derby, slouch, card player or other). Popular in the time period, you may also consider adding in facial hair. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see please see the party tips section at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the guest info and costuming sections on the website.*

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